https://surhak.vercel.app/



SUREN HAKOBYAN

Senior Frontend Engineer | AI-native Product Engineer

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ABOUT ME

I build the hard part of product UI: editors, workflow builders and AI features, in high-performance web apps that millions of people use daily. Over 8+ years, I've shipped production products for Picsart (400M+ users), Warner Music Group, Empire, Simplified, JobLeads and Toptal, specializing in complex visual editors (Canvas, Konva.js, Fabric.js), node-based workflow builders (React Flow), AI-integrated interfaces and scalable SaaS architecture. Full ownership mindset: from architecture planning and CI/CD setup to mentoring teams, code reviews and stakeholder communication. I work agent-first and build the system around it: composable Claude Code skills, review gates, model routing, custom MCP servers and a learning loop that turns review feedback into rules, so the speed shows up as shipped work.

Experience

Toptal *https://www.toptal.com*

Remote

Senior Frontend Engineer

06/2026 - Present

Full-time on Toptal's in-house product team, building Toptal's own **Applicant Tracking System (ATS):** the hiring platform that powers how **Toptal** screens and moves candidates through hiring. Working in a large-scale **React** + **TypeScript** monorepo backed by **GraphQL**.

- Built frontend for an interactive, node-based workflow builder in React + TypeScript on a canvas engine (React Flow): drag-and-drop editing, real-time branching visualization, and pan/zoom controls
- Built an agentic engineering workspace for the ATS codebase: 30+ composable Claude Code skills, hooks and review gates, model routing by task, and a learning loop that turns merged-PR review comments into rules loaded at planning and review
- Wrote an MCP server for our internal agent platform that runs parallel containerized agent sessions, each on its own git worktree
- Built data-intensive dashboards on GraphQL (Apollo Client): server-driven filtering, bulk actions, pagination, and complex state management
- Shipped reusable, accessible UI building blocks across the product: dynamic forms, file upload, browser media capture, and rich content
- Contributed components and icons to a Tailwind-based design system, applying token-driven theming and consistent UI patterns
- Delivered frontend modernization work in a large monorepo: module and route refactors, service decoupling, unit and component testing (Jest · React Testing Library), and code review
- Own initiatives from concept to production, not only the hardest slice

JobLeads *https://www.jobleads.com*

Hamburg, Germany | Remote

Frontend Software Engineer

07/2024 - 06/2026

Started in the **Resume World** team shipping **AI-powered** features (**AI Resume Builder** & **Resume Review**), then moved to the **User Acquisition** team, owning frontend engineering for **SEO**, conversion optimization, and growth tools that directly drive platform revenue.

- Built and optimized high-converting landing pages and SEO-driven content pages, directly impacting user acquisition metrics and organic traffic growth
- Implemented A/B testing frameworks and conversion experiments across the acquisition funnel, translating test results into measurable improvements in sign-up and activation rates
- Developed internal marketing and growth tools used by the acquisition team to scale campaigns and automate workflows
- Optimized Core Web Vitals and page performance for SEO ranking signals, achieving 90+ Lighthouse scores across key landing pages
- Architected and shipped AI Resume Builder and AI Resume Review features with NLP-driven scoring, auto-suggestions, and intelligent formatting, now a core product differentiator
- Designed a reusable component library using Vue 3 Composition API, cutting new feature development time by ~30%
- Reduced page load time by ~35% through code-splitting, lazy loading, and caching optimizations
- Worked on the Vue 2 → Vue 3 migration, modernizing the codebase to Composition API and improving maintainability across the platform

Experience

Simplified *https://app.simplified.com*

San Francisco, United States | Remote

Frontend Software Engineer

11/2021 - 07/2024

Primary owner of the **AI Photo/Video Editor** module, the most technically complex part of the platform, built on **Canvas** with **Fabric.js**. Part of a 20+ engineer frontend team.

- Owned end-to-end development of the AI Photo/Video/Audio Editor: real-time image/video/audio processing, layering systems, filters, transformations, Canvas rendering, audio waveform editing, and AI-powered enhancements using Fabric.js
- Designed the frontend layer for AI-powered editor features: the UI that translates AI outputs into intuitive user interactions, handling edge cases and fallbacks that require human UX judgment
- Worked directly with the CTO on technical prioritization, resource allocation, and roadmap planning for the editor product
- Conducted daily code reviews across the frontend team, identifying architectural issues early and maintaining consistent quality standards across 20+ engineers
- Mentored 3+ junior engineers with structured guidance on Canvas internals, frontend best practices, and complex problem solving, accelerating their path to independent feature delivery
- Built and maintained the real-time WebSocket communication layer for live collaborative interactions within the editor
- Evaluated and integrated emerging AI capabilities and frontend frameworks, keeping the editor at the cutting edge of browser-based creative tools
- Collaborated with product, design, QA, and backend teams to translate user needs into technical solutions, ensuring seamless integration across the full application

ENKE Systems

New York, United States | Remote

Frontend Software Engineer

03/2021 - 12/2025

Outstaffed frontend engineer through ENKE Systems (employer of record), delivering 5 production applications (CRM, CMS, Release Management) for **Warner Music Group** and **Empire,** two of the world's largest music companies.

- Developed and shipped 5 enterprise music-industry web applications from initial setup to production deployment and ongoing support, including audio metadata handling, music release workflows, and content management for Warner Music Group and Empire
- Projects included Warner Chappell Music's Arrow licensing portal (advanced search, audio playback, waveform visualization) and a customized Apache Superset dashboard for supply-chain analytics with custom chart types
- Directly communicated with Warner Music and Empire business stakeholders: gathering requirements, translating them into technical specifications, and reporting progress across time zones
- Contributed to architecture planning and tech stack decisions for all 5 projects, collaborating with team leads and DevOps to establish component structure, state management patterns, and CI/CD pipelines
- Conducted systematic code reviews across the multi-project codebase, maintaining code quality standards and ensuring consistency across the engineering team
- Built frontend features using React, Redux, TypeScript, and Material UI: responsive UI components, SCSS modules, and reusable patterns shared across all applications
- Delivered all projects on time and within budget, presenting regular progress updates and milestone reports to project stakeholders
- Maintained production applications post-launch within a contracted 4 to 6 hr/month support window: troubleshooting, bug fixes, and feature enhancements
- Implemented unit and E2E test automation, ensuring reliability across critical user workflows before every release
- Led the Angular → React migration across project codebases, modernizing the frontend architecture and improving developer productivity

Picsart

https://picsart.com/create

Yerevan, Armenia | Hybrid

Frontend Software Engineer

03/2018 - 11/2021

Founding frontend engineer on Picsart's **Creative Photo Editor,** built from scratch using **Canvas (Konva.js)** in a 50-person team with 28 engineers, organized in cross-functional sub-teams of 5 to 6 (engineers, QA, EM, designer). Picsart is used by 400M+ people worldwide.

- Part of the founding team that built Picsart's online Photo Editor from the very first line of code, architecting Canvas-based features with Konva.js, React, Redux, TypeScript, and ReactJSS
- Developed core editor features including brushes, filters, layers, text tools, and image transformations, working within one of the editor's cross-functional sub-teams
- Independently built and deployed 5 WeChat mini-applications, expanding Picsart's presence to the WeChat ecosystem (1B+ potential users in the Chinese market)
- Contributed to code reviews, sprint planning, and architecture discussions, helping shape engineering standards and technical direction during the product's critical early growth phase
- Worked cross-functionally with QA, Design, and Backend teams to coordinate feature delivery, incorporate feedback, and maintain quality across rapid release cycles
- Adapted to and helped drive the team's transition from Kanban to Scrum, improving sprint predictability and delivery cadence

Experience

Projects (Freelance / Contract / Volunteer)

Remote

Frontend Software Engineer

09/2018 - Present

Worked on 15+ projects across fintech, blockchain, real estate, multiplatform, and gaming, as sole developer or within small teams, with full frontend ownership from architecture to deployment.

- **inflyu** - Solo-built AI creative platform with 10,000+ users: RAG prompt engine, 20+ tool editors (2025 - now) | Next.js, React, TypeScript
- **Libertex** - Built frontend for a fintech trading platform serving stocks, CFDs, Forex, and cryptocurrency markets, working across a legacy codebase modernization effort | Vue, Backbone.js, TypeScript, Drupal
- **Sberbank** - Frontend engineer on an Online School platform for Russia's largest bank, building complex data visualizations and modular UI components within a large cross-functional team | React, Effector.js, GraphQL, Apollo Client, Chart.js, Storybook, SCSS
- **Factoring, Hellopay, GamesBoost42** - Built CRM and CMS applications for fintech clients and a gaming-funding admin dashboard, implementing data-heavy dashboards, reporting interfaces, and complex form workflows | React, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Material UI, Recharts, React Hook Form
- **Stihi, CW, Savva** - Developed a cryptocurrency exchange platform with real-time trading interfaces, live price feeds, and blockchain integration, plus a cross-chain bridge on PulseChain | React, MobX, Axios, Quill, EOSJS, Web3, SCSS, Styled Components
- **Edi-Real** - Built a full multiplatform application (desktop, web, mobile) for real estate property management, handling Big Data visualization across all three platforms | React, Electron, React Native, Redux, Big Data
- **Boo** - Developed cross-platform applications integrating C++ libraries with web technologies through WebAssembly, including interactive map features and geolocation | C++, Qt QML, WebAssembly, Maps, Leaflet.js, React, Electron
- **Arburg** - Contributed to a 3D printer application forked from Ultimaker Cura, bridging Python backend with frontend interfaces | Python, Qt QML, React
- **Dats, Bet Andreas** - Built frontend for gambling and sports betting platforms with server-side rendering, live odds updates, and optimized performance | React, Redux, Next.js, TypeScript, WebSockets, Axios, Lodash.js, SCSS, Core UI
- **Vecteezy** - Built frontend for a stock media and vector graphics marketplace with advanced search | React, TypeScript, Redux
- **BookedBy** - Built frontend for an all-in-one salon management platform with booking and reporting | React, TypeScript, Node.js

Skills

- **Main** - TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Vue, Nuxt.js, Canvas (2D), React Flow, Redux, Qt QML
- **HTML5 Canvas** - Konva.js, Fabric.js, Image/Video Processing, Real-time Rendering, Layering Systems, Filters, Transformations
- **State Management** - Redux (Toolkit), MobX, Zustand, Recoil, Effector.js, Vuex, Pinia
- **UI Components** - shadcn/ui, Radix UI, Headless UI, Material UI, Chakra UI, Ant Design, Vuetify, Core UI
- **Styles** - CSS, SCSS, SASS, LESS, Styled Components, Tailwind CSS, React JSS, PostCSS, Framer Motion
- **Design Engineering** - Figma to Code Agent, Design Systems, Design Tokens, Figma, Figma Dev Mode, Storybook, Web Accessibility (WCAG), Core Web Vitals, Lighthouse
- **Build Tools** - Webpack, Vite, Rollup
- **Git** - GitHub, Bitbucket, GitLab
- **Tests** - Unit, Integration, E2E, Cypress, Playwright, React Testing Library, Vitest, Jest
- **Mobile & Multiplatform** - React Native, Expo, Expo Router, Reanimated, Mobile Architecture (shared web + mobile monorepo), Electron.js, Qt QML, WeChat Mini Apps
- **AI & Agentic** - Claude Code (skills, hooks, subagents), Cursor, Codex, MCP (custom servers), agent orchestration, model routing, review gates, LLM API integration (Claude, OpenAI), RAG (Pinecone, embeddings)
- **MCP & CLI** - Atlassian MCP (Jira, Confluence), Playwright MCP, Chrome DevTools MCP, Figma MCP, Slack MCP, Sentry MCP, Grafana MCP, Context7, Neon MCP, Cloudflare MCP, custom MCP servers, GitHub CLI, GitLab CLI, Atlassian CLI, Vercel CLI, Wrangler, AWS CLI, gcloud, kubectl
- **SSR/SSG** - Next.js (SSR, SSG, CSR), Nuxt.js (SSR, SSG), React Server Components, Streaming SSR
- **API & Data** - React Query (TanStack Query), Zod, GraphQL, Apollo Client, REST APIs, WebSocket, Firebase, Axios
- **Data Visualization** - Chart.js, Apache ECharts, Apache Superset, Recharts, Leaflet.js, Maps
- **Other** - WebAssembly, Node.js, Express.js, Redux Form, React Hook Form, Quill, Lodash.js, Blockchain, Big Data, Performance Optimization, Code Refactoring, Code Review, Linux, OOP, Algorithms, Data Structures, Turborepo, Prisma, Docker, Micro-frontends, Web Workers
- **Methodologies** - Agile, Scrum, Kanban, CI/CD, Cross-functional Collaboration
- **Leadership** - Technical Mentoring, Daily Code Reviews, Team Management, Stakeholder Communication, Architecture Planning, Project Delivery
- **Problem Domains & Soft Skills** - Visual Editor Architecture, Real-time Collaboration, AI Feature Integration, Performance & Growth Engineering, Cross-platform Development, Enterprise Delivery, Product Decisions, Technical Vision

Education

Yerevan State University

Yerevan, Armenia

Bachelor of Informatics and Applied Mathematics

2013 - 2020

Languages

Armenian (Native) · English (Full professional) · Russian (Full professional) · Spanish (Elementary)